

Chapter 120-5

Liang Shi smiled helplessly, her hand dropping down. "Nothing escapes you."

Xu Qingzhu tucked the greeting card back into the baby's breath, leaned forward, and hugged Liang Shi with the bouquet between them.

Xu Qingzhu didn't ask about what Liang Shi saw or heard when meeting Chen Mian. She only asked: "Teacher Liang, what do you want to eat for lunch today?"

Just like how she had said—Xu Qingzhu, have you not been eating properly?

The tone was familiar, carrying a touch of gentleness.

Amidst this clamor, the heart that had just been restless and lonely was soothed in an instant.

Liang Shi revealed a smile, her tone indulgent: "I'll eat whatever you eat."

Xu Qingzhu thought for half a second. "Is roast duck okay?"

Liang Shi nodded: "Sure."

The cold sun shone upon the earth, and the late autumn wind blew past at an inopportune time.

Yet it didn't make anyone feel cold.

That roast duck restaurant wasn't far—just around the corner, no need to drive.

Xu Qingzhu held the purple baby's breath in her arms. Along the way, they encountered employees from her company, and she kept a cold expression the entire time.

After walking just a few steps, neither knew who moved closer first, who reached out first.

Liang Shi's fingers hooked onto Xu Qingzhu's fingers.

Fingers intertwined.

Even their retreating figures looked exceptionally beautiful.

This scene fell into Chen Liuying's eyes from not far away, and it was especially glaring.

Chen Liuying had been there for a while.

She hadn't gone out in a long time. Today, on a whim, she went out for a walk and unknowingly wandered to the Minghui Jewelry building.

Since she was already here, she thought she'd find Xu Qingzhu and meet with her.

She simply wanted to come find Xu Qingzhu to chat, though she didn't know what about.

Perhaps all beautiful things have thorns, like roses.

Xu Qingzhu was at the top of the food chain among roses.

No one could have imagined that she would actually keep a recording as evidence back then.

In the past month or so, Chen Liuying had lost her endorsements, lost her drama contracts, lost her girlfriend, and several companies were suing her for breach of contract.

She had been to court three times alone, and was carrying tens of millions in debt.

What should have been a bright future was now completely ruined.

Ruined by that recording of Xu Qingzhu's.

Ruined by their step-by-step strategic PR campaign.

If back then she had been shallow, not understanding why she lost so badly, not understanding how things had come to that point.

Then looking back on it now, what was there not to understand?

It was clearly to lure her out from behind the scenes, to make her face public condemnation—that's why they had laid trap after trap.

Until she thought she had enough certainty to win.

Yet she never expected to fail at the last hurdle, losing in utter disgrace.

She blamed Bai Weiwei for being stupid without knowing it, blamed Bai Weiwei for being too jealous.

She also blamed herself for not being able to keep her composure.

Chen Liuying loved beautiful things. The first time she saw Xu Qingzhu, she thought this person was beautiful.

So beautiful it made you want to take a taste.

These days she had also been constantly trying to make a comeback, but every attempt ended in miserable failure.

Besides infamy, she got nothing.

But why?

She had worked so hard to get to that point—what did those young misses who were born with everything understand?

They understood nothing.

Chen Liuying's clothes were out of season, long pants and long sleeves, looking exceptionally plain.

She didn't look like a female celebrity at all.

Those glamorous days were gone. She could no longer stand under the spotlight, admired by thousands.

Her life was wretched, unbearable, covered in mud.

Yet those people were clean and pristine, their lives going smoothly, living in the sunshine, living in love.

It looked so beautiful.

What was there to envy?

A shadow flickered through Chen Liuying's eyes.

She thought: If I can't have it, I might as well destroy it.

Isn't the meaning of beautiful things' existence to be destroyed?

More beautiful than existing beauty is beauty that has been burned to ashes.